TapSlam

Early-Game Progression

MINICLIP

Presented by Thomas Wai on 2026-04-15

Presentation Agenda

- **Game Context: Defining the "Tier" Progression System.**
- **Defining Our Player Cohorts**
- **The Problem: Identifying the root causes of early-game churn (Tiers 1-3).**
- **The Data: The Progression Wall.**
- **Monetisation: Why Ads and In-App Purchases are not to blame.**
- **Action Plan: Proposed mechanics changes & A/B Testing strategy.**

Defining Our Player Cohorts

Player Cohort Definitions (Segmenting behavior based on a standard 30-day month)

Power Users (>25 Days Active)

Play 80%+ of the month

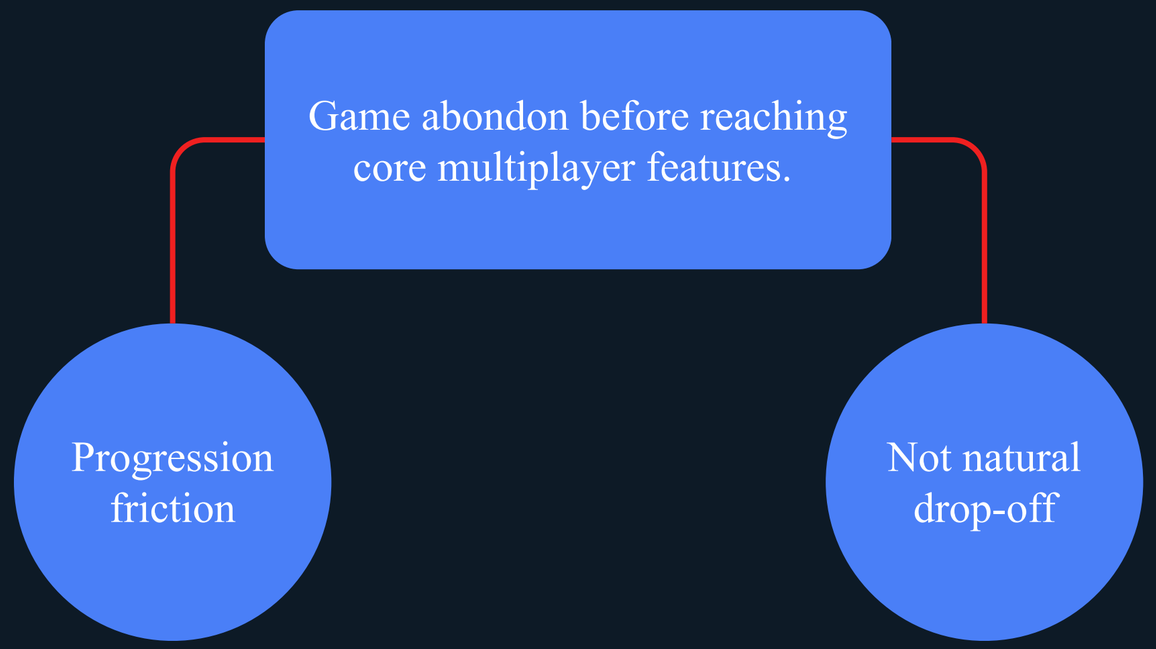
Regular Users (3–25 Days Active)

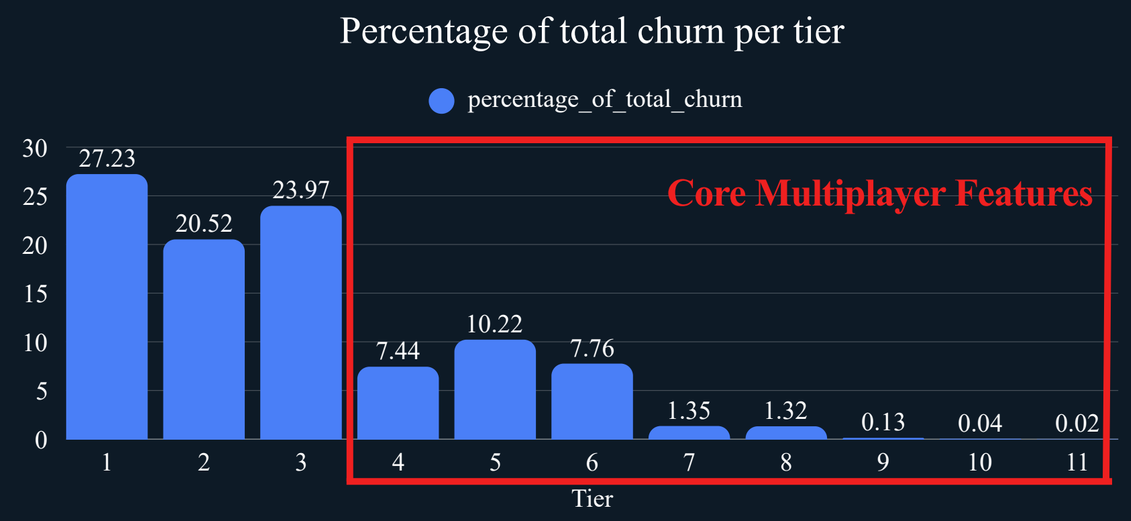
Churned Users (<3 Days Active)

Play less than 10% of the month

Executive Summary

The Churn Funnel: 71.7% drop off in Tiers 1–3.





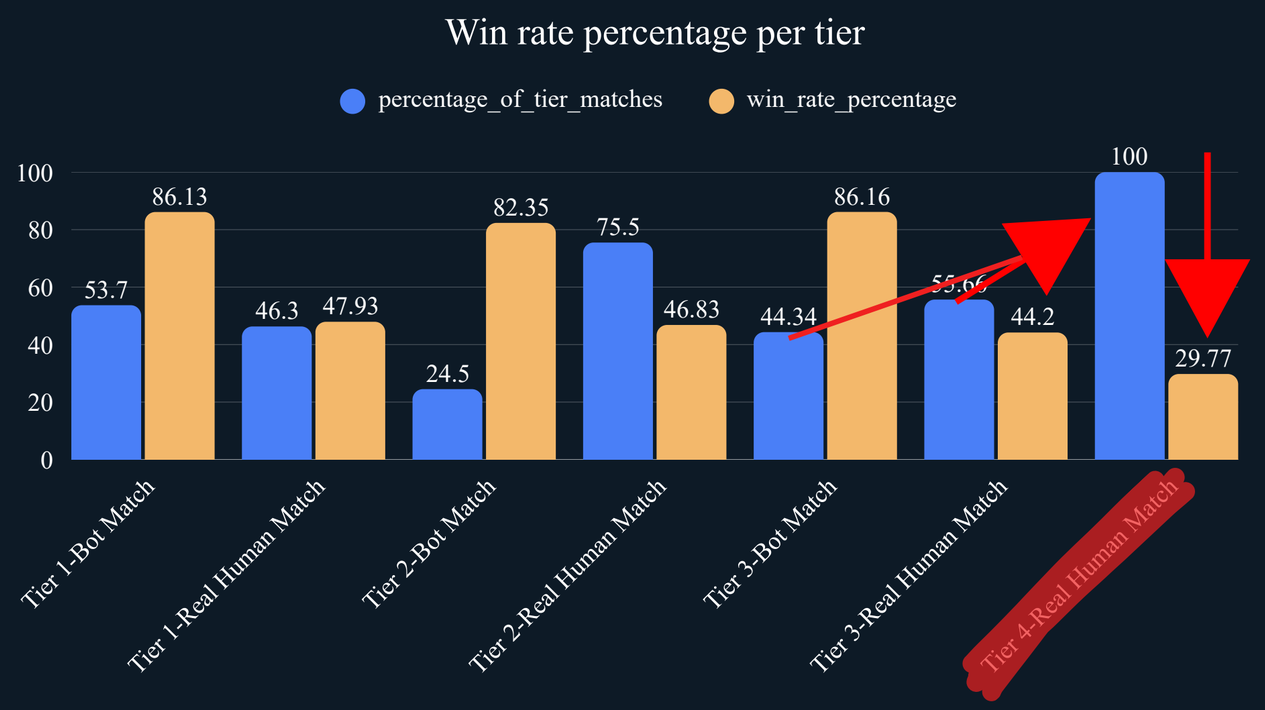
The "Difficulty Whiplash" Effect

Bots vs. Humans

- Tiers 1–3 (The Bot Pool):
  Artificially high win rate (82–86%).

- Tier 4 (The Human Wall):
  Bots are removed; win rate collapses to 29.7%.

Takeaway: Bots fail to prepare players for real competition.



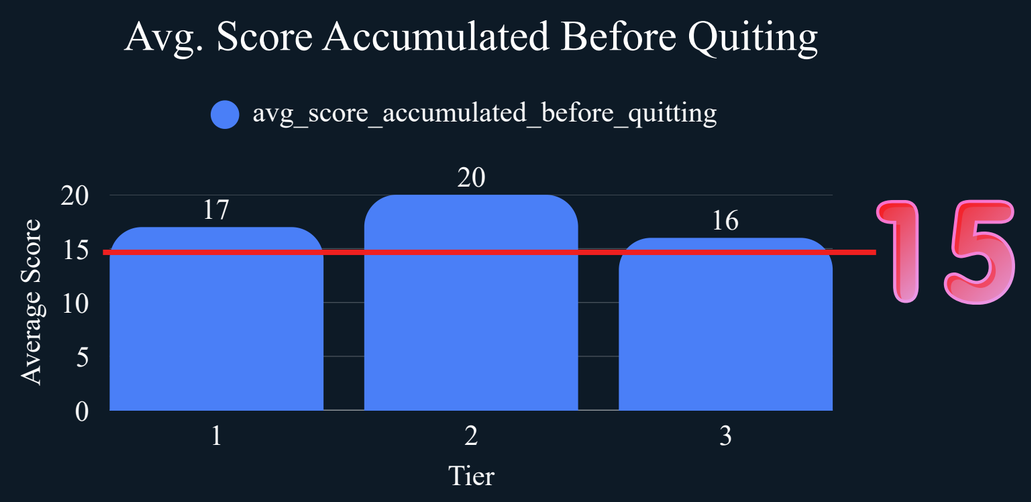
Progression Wall

Early-Game Grind Exceeds Player Patience.

- Tolerance is strictly 1.5 to 2.0 matches per early tier.
- The breaking point: Players quit after earning 16–20 points.

Takeaway: Tiers 1–3 require more grinding than new players will tolerate.

- Proposed Maximum Tier Requirement (<15 Pts)

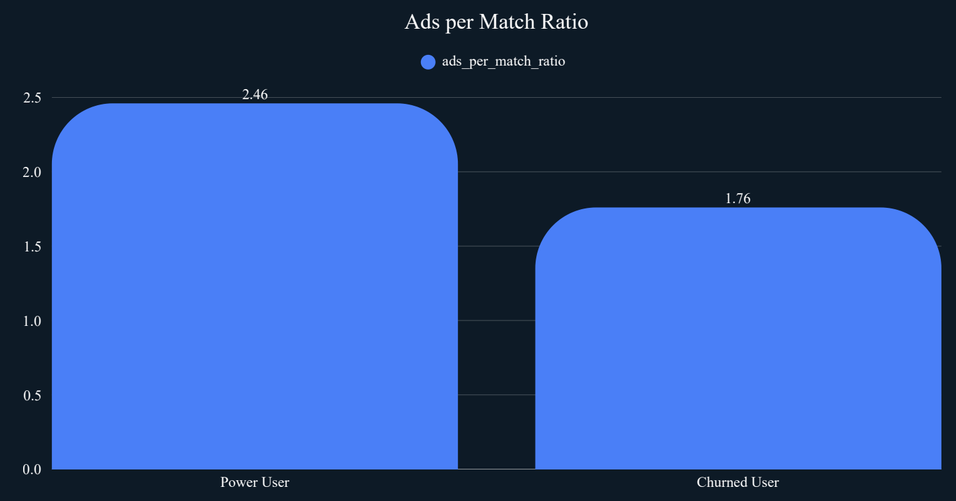


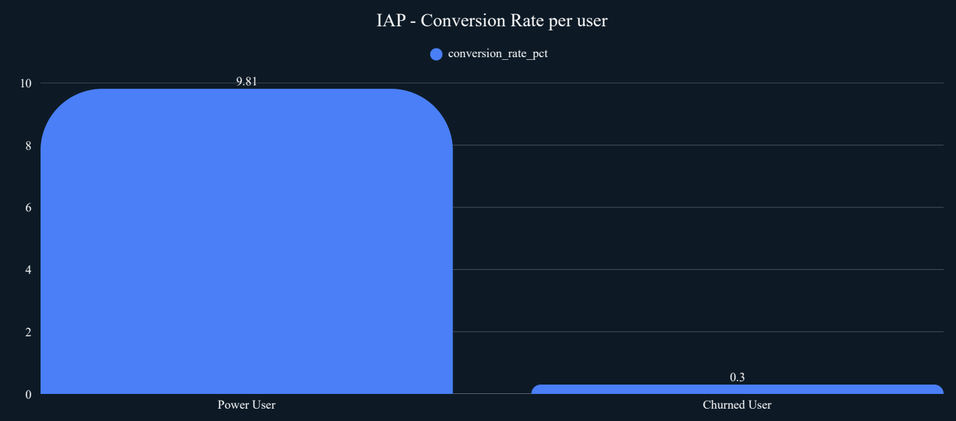
Early Game Churn Tier	Avg. Matches Played Before Quitting
Tier 1	1.6 Matches
Tier 2	2.0 Matches
Tier 3	1.5 Matches

Ruling Out Monetisation (Ads & IAP)

- Ad Fatigue is a Myth: Power Users watch more ads (2.46/match) than Churned Users (1.76/match).
- The Conversion Chasm: Power Users are ~33 times more likely to spend money (9.81% conversion) compared to Churned Users (0.30%).
- No Pay-To-Win Churn: 18 Churned users spent up to £11.97 and still quit within 48 hours.

Takeaway: Gameplay friction drives early churn, not monetisation strategy.





Product Action Plan & Tracking

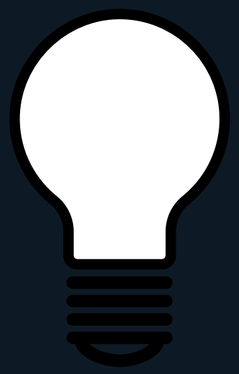
Product Calls to Action (CTAs):

- CTA 1: Compress Early Progression: Hard-cap Tiers 1, 2, and 3 at a maximum of 15 points to guarantee progression within 2 matches.
- CTA 2: Dynamic Bot Tapering: Implement an alternating matchmaking pattern in Tiers 2 and 3 (1 Bot Match → 1 Human Match) to ease the difficulty transition.

Tracking Metrics & Success Criteria:

- Primary Metric: Tier 4 Attainment Rate.
- Secondary Metric 1: Average matches required to reach Tier 4 (Target: Decrease).
- Secondary Metric 2: First-Human-Match Win Rate (Target: Stabilise near ~45-50%).
- Secondary Metric 3: Day 1 (D1) and Day 3 (D3) Retention.

A/B Testing Strategy (14–21 Days)



1. **Control (Group A): Current progression and bot logic.**
2. **Variant 1 (Group B): Accelerated Progression only (<15 pts).**
3. **Variant 2 (Group C): Accelerated Progression + Alternating Matchmaking (1 Bot → 1 Human).**

- Guardrail Metric: ARPU (Average Revenue Per User)
- Risk: Short-term ad impression dip in Tiers 1–3 must be offset by higher retained LTV.

Thank you

We welcome your inquiries and feedback regarding our findings.